

actually an advanced version of the company's previous product UArm Metal. UArm swift comes in two versions, vanilla and pro. The upgrade in pro comes with a more precise repeatability. The best part? It's open source.

Another upcoming member of the open source field is **Ziro**. A robotics kit which is controlled by a glove. At its core, Ziro is a set of motors. You craft your robot around these motors and then programme hand gestures to movements of the motors. This can be done through a simple smart-phone app. What is the robot made of? Anything. The creators presented Ziro with robots made out of cardboard, so you know there's a large pool of possibilities.

The ones for transportation

Those that are

Robotics in transportation is still in its infancy, most of the technologies are in development. But one robot has already been doing its job for over four years now. NASA's Curiosity Rover has been at work on Mars since August 2012. More than being a tool for consumers, Curiosity is actually a tool for the whole of humanity. It was the first to find out the most promising clues to the origins of the red planet. It constantly studies the atmosphere, digs up holes to collect and study rocks and dirt and sends the data from these studies back to Earth. As of the time of writing, the rover is planned to stay for an additional two years on the red planet.

Special mention

Hate them or not, autonomous vehicles are now the main act unfolding in the robotics theatre. Even if you despise a machine taking over your controls, you cannot underestimate the size of this new wave. Many large automobile companies and startups all over the world are engaged in making autonomous vehicles a reality. Companies like Tesla, Ford, Mercedes and Google have been an active part of this segment. Apart from these, there are a plethora of startups too. NEXT Future Transportation and Otto are working on large autonomous road vehicles. Faraday Future and LeEco have partnered together to work on cars. Then there are companies like AdasWorks, Cruise, DriveAI, Nauto and Princeton Lightwave are just examples of the many small companies working on AI systems. So despite being 'unorthodox', it would be interesting to see what these companies bring up. In the end, we are going to be the users and therefore we can decide, what works and what doesn't.